

Industrial Arts Workshop

Executive Summary

Client

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Background

The Industrial Arts Workshop (IAW) is a Pittsburgh-based nonprofit located in the Hazelwood neighborhood. Founded in 2014, IAW empowers local youth by providing extracurricular programs including after-school welding labs, intensive summer bootcamps, and community workshops. The organization operates with a small professional staff and is funded through a mix of grants, individual donations, program fees, and institutional partnerships. Prior to this engagement, IAW managed donor and constituent data across a fragmented set of tools including PayPal, MailChimp, QuickBooks, and Google Sheets, with limited integration between systems.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

IAW's donor management infrastructure had not scaled alongside its programming growth and capital campaign ambitions. The absence of a centralized constituent relationship management (CRM) system created inefficiencies in donor tracking, event management, grant recordkeeping, and financial reconciliation. Staff time was spent on manual cross-referencing across disconnected platforms, and the organization needed a more sophisticated fundraising operation.

Project Vision

The consulting team set out to evaluate and recommend a nonprofit-specific CRM platform to centralize IAW's fundraising and constituent data, reduce manual administrative burden, and establish sustainable donor stewardship infrastructure. The team further aimed to support IAW through the implementation process by migrating data, digitizing workflows, and equipping staff with the documentation needed to manage the system independently going forward.

Project Outcomes

IAW successfully adopted Neon One as its CRM platform. On the technology side, IAW's grants

data was migrated into Neon One via a properly formatted CSV prepared by the consulting team and uploaded by IAW staff, establishing a clean centralized record. A custom dashboard was configured within Neon One for Executive Director Tim to optimize his day-to-day visibility into organizational data. An existing hybrid paper/digital consent form workflow was recreated in Neon One, with a process established for IAW staff to scan physically signed forms from families and associate them with the correct constituent accounts. On the process side, staff were equipped with documentation guides covering key platform features, including the BCC email functionality and dashboard customization instructions, supporting independent use of the system. The client relationship management responsibilities held by the consulting team modeled clear communication and transition practices that IAW can carry forward as with future partners.

Project Deliverables

Deliverables include: a CRM evaluation and recommendation report with a decision matrix comparing Bloomerang, Keela, and Neon One; corporate/foundations grants records uploaded to Neon One; a custom Neon One dashboard configured for the Executive Director; a digitized consent form workflow hosted within Neon One, including a scanning process for paper signatures; and a set of staff documentation guides covering the BCC feature and platform customization. The full report contains instructions for accessing all deliverables.

Recommendations

IAW should continue using Neon One as its centralized system, ensuring all new data is entered directly and leveraging BCC and segmentation features for targeted donor outreach. Staff should conduct regular data reviews and maintain Google Drive as the primary source of truth for Neon One CRM training and reference, updating documentation as workflows evolve. A future project should develop a plain HTML email template to support more professional, high-touch communications.

Student Consulting Team

Cici Ge served as Project Manager. She is a junior majoring in Information Systems with a minor in Artificial Intelligence. She will be interning at ServiceLink this summer and is interested in a career at the intersection of technology and social impact.

Bo Xie led Client Relationship Management. He is a junior majoring in Information Systems with a minor in Machine Learning. He will be supporting data-driven marketing & growth efforts at two early-stage startups in Pittsburgh this summer.

Sophia Zhu served as Quality Assurance Lead and Client Transition Lead. She is a graduating senior majoring in Information Systems with minors in Computer Science and Business Administration. She will be working full-time at Amazon as a Software Development Engineer.